

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

I regret doing that!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What are the most common mistakes that people make in a job interview?
- Which ones have you made?

Can Do Statements

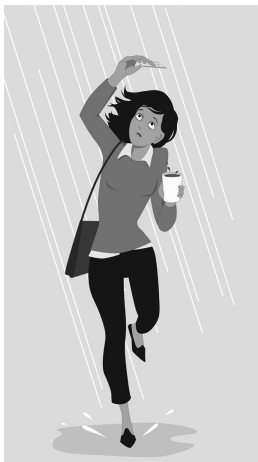
- I can talk about events and experiences related to jobs.
- I can discuss hypothetical situations in the past.
- I can participate in interviews.





Let's Explore!

That was definitely a bad interview!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Boris:** Ms. Concerto, have a seat. How are you doing today?
Claire: Well, to tell you the truth, it's been kind of a bad day.
Boris: Oh? I'm sorry to hear that.
Claire: Yes. Well, it's raining. I don't really like rainy days ...
Kristi: Geez, this interview has started off on the wrong foot. The question was only meant as polite conversation. She responded as if she was speaking to a good friend. She shouldn't have said that. It sounds informal. She should have responded more formally. She could have said, "Fine thank you. And you?" That's a much more appropriate answer.
- Boris:** So how about on a good day? What do you like to do in your spare time?
Claire: I like reading and uh ... watching TV.
Boris: What's your favorite TV show?
Claire: Oh I love *The Office*! It's so funny! Not the American version though, the British one. British people are so funny, you know?
Boris: Yes ... they can be ...
Kristi: She's very talkative. The interviewer is trying to make small talk and she's just rambling on. She should have responded in a way that reflected positively on her overall character and professionalism.
- Boris:** Okay, let's get down to business. Can you tell me a bit about your previous experience?
Claire: Hmm ... my uncle managed a print shop, and I helped him out a lot. I would be perfect for this job ...
Kristi: Oh brother. What a mess. I wouldn't have said that. Guess my chances are much better now!





Let's Practice!

Claire is messing up* in her interview.

* "Messing up" means doing poorly at something.

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. Geez, this interview has _____.
2. The interviewer is trying to make small talk and she's just _____ on.
3. She should have answered in a way that reflected _____ on her overall character and _____.
4. She should have answered more _____.

Word Bank

- rambling
- formally
- professionalism
- positively
- started off on the wrong foot



Let's Practice!

Claire should have ...

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select the correct answer to complete each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. She _____ said that, it comes off as being informal.
(should have / shouldn't have)
2. She _____ answered more formally.
(should have / shouldn't have)
3. She _____ said, "Fine thank you. And you?"
(could have / couldn't have)
4. I _____ been perfect for this job.
(would have / wouldn't have)
5. I _____ said that.
(would have / wouldn't have)





Extension Activity

Talking about a bad job interview!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a story about your worst job interview experience.
- If you don't have one, make one up.
- Be very detailed in your description.
- What would you have done differently and what you will do next time?
- Use passive modals to explain what you would have changed.
- Get into groups and compare stories.
- Vote on the best one.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about a job interview.

☐ ☐

I explain what I regretted.

☐ ☐

I explain what I would have changed.

☐ ☐

I reflect on my experience and talk about what I will do next time.

☐ ☐

I present my story clearly and concisely.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to ramble on** (verb): to talk without stopping
e.g. The interviewer is trying to make small talk and she's just rambling on.
- **to start off on the wrong foot** (expression): to begin in an awkward or unpleasant way
e.g. This interview has started off on the wrong foot.
- **formally** (adverb): in a formal way
e.g. She should have answered more formally.
- **professionalism** (noun): an attitude appropriate for the workplace
e.g. She should have answered in a way that demonstrated her professionalism.
- **positively** (adverb): in a good way
e.g. Her answer reflected positively on her overall character.





Learning Points

The Future Tense

There are four different tenses that talk about the future.

Will:

- When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future.

For example:

I will call you later.

Be going to:

- When you ask about intentions.

For example:

Are you going to go to the meeting later?

Present Continuous:

- When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future.

For example:

The meeting is happening at 9 a.m. sharp tomorrow.

Simple Present:

- When you talk about schedules.

For example:

The presentation starts at 3:30.

Examples:

- *I am running errands today.*
- *It's on tonight at five.*
- *I am going to work really hard. I promise.*
- *I will definitely be better than this woman.*





Learning Points

Talking Hypothetically About the Past

Would have, should have and **could have** can be used to talk about hypothetical situations in the past that may or may not be true.

Could have (+ past participle)

Could have expresses an action that was possible at some time in the past, but it wasn't done.

*I **could have gotten that job**, if I applied earlier.*

You also use **could have** to suggest how an action in the past that was not done would have led to a different situation in the present.

Why is Mark not here yet?

*He **could have been** stuck in traffic or he **could have overslept**.*

Should have (+ past participle)

Should have is used for giving advice for past events. We often use it to display regret when we think something was a good idea in the past, but we didn't do it.

*I **should have applied** sooner.*

(I regret not applying sooner).

*You **shouldn't have answered** that question like that.*

(You should have answered that question in another way).

Would have (+ past participle)

Would have expresses a regret about an action you did not do in the past but you now wish you had.

*I **would have gone** to your concert, but I didn't know the date.*

(I wanted to go to your concert but I didn't know the date, so I didn't go.)

Examples:

- *She **shouldn't have said** that, it comes off as being informal.*
- *She **should have answered** more formally.*
- *She **could have said**, "Fine thank you. And you?"*
- *I **would have been** perfect for this job.*
- *I **wouldn't have said** that.*

